

Nick Heindl

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Accessibility Leader with a Technical Background

Nick has an infectious passion for game accessibility and empowering teams to do their best work.

Coming from a background in gameplay engineering and tech design, Nick can effectively communicate across all roles involved in a game's creation, and as a result has been consistently relied upon to jump into new areas and solve hard problems to make our games more inclusive.

Nick's latest position at ZeniMax Online Studios had him combine his technical background with his expertise of inclusive design to form a new team dedicated to ensuring a AAA MMORPG, made with a new IP and tech stack, would be accessible from Day 1.

Selected Professional Experience

ZeniMax Online Studios (Xbox, Bethesda)

August 2021 – Present

Accessibility Team Lead and Principal Technical Designer

Unannounced AAA MMORPG (350+ devs)

- Founded and led a new Accessibility Team for a large-scale MMORPG project
- Drove strategy for player-facing and developer-facing accessibility features and infrastructure
- Defined goals and KPIs for various development phases (pre-prod to post-launch)
- Ensured we were on track to meet (and exceed) legal and publishing standards
- Collaborated closely with internal and external stakeholders to create multi-year roadmaps
- Contributed to Xbox-wide talks and initiatives related to Design, Accessibility, and Publishing
- Ran workshops, presentations, and 1-1s to build a culture of empathy and inclusive design
- Ran playtests alongside UR and UX in effort to collate feedback into prioritized action items
- Performed technical evaluations and breakdowns of third-party software, (IRIS, Chroma, etc.)
- Worked closely with 3Cs team to balance movement and camera to minimize Sim Sickness
- Partnered with Combat team to revamp Aim Assist systems and give designers live-edit tooling
- Created a demo to showcase assistive devices utilizing our input binding tech
- Established standards for text scaling on multiple platforms (Console, PC, Handheld, Mobile)
- Technical Product Owner of Narrative Systems from first implementation through prototype

PUBG Corporation

October 2020 – July 2021

Software Engineer

PlayerUnknown's Battlegrounds (PUBG)

- Bolstered a new remote workflow to support non-technical staff
- Assisted Tech Director with setting up a new recruiting and interviewing process

Raven Software (Activision Blizzard)

Summer 2015 – October 2020

Gameplay Engineer

Call of Duty: Warzone, Modern Warfare, Cold War, Black Ops IIII, Online (China only)

- Led small team to design, architect, and implement Warzone's Ping Marker system
- Certified Accessible Player Experience Practitioner (CAPXP): accessible.games/apxp
- Prototyped, polished, and shipped many features and game modes for a worldwide audience
- Engineering mentor to interns and folks in many departments (Eng./Design/QA)